AFRICAN SOLIDARITY CIVIC ORGANISATION (ASCO)
Registered NPC: 2026/521895/08
SARS Approved PBO: 930092287
Section 18A approved: 9 October 2026
+27 76 757 5773
www.africansolidaritycivic.org

CORPORATE CSI PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

# Absa Group Limited × ASCO

## Youth Green Enterprise and Community Resilience Initiative

**Requested CSI investment:** R100,000

**Proposed implementation area:** South Africa; select one ASCO-served community after confirming need, municipal permission and Absa's preferred territory (suggested initial focus: Gauteng, subject to validation).

**Prepared:** October 2026

Confidential proposal for corporate CSI / ESG consideration. This document presents a proposed partnership and does not represent an award, endorsement, existing partnership or company commitment.

## Executive summary

ASCO is seeking a strategic corporate CSI partnership with **Absa Group Limited** to support a measurable public-benefit initiative: **Youth Green Enterprise and Community Resilience Initiative**. The proposed request is **R100,000**, to be applied to direct programme delivery, participation access, safety, learning materials, monitoring and accountable reporting.

ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.

> **The proposal in one sentence:** Youth Green Enterprise and Community Resilience Initiative in South Africa; select one ASCO-served community after confirming need, municipal permission and Absa's preferred territory (suggested initial focus: Gauteng, subject to validation)., benefiting Proposed: unemployed or underemployed young people, including young women, from an underserved South African community, plus local schools/community organisations and micro-entrepreneurs who benefit from environmental and financial-literacy activities. through a locally designed, monitored and reportable intervention aligned with Absa Group Limited's publicly documented priorities, subject to the company's confirmation of eligibility and application requirements.

**What ASCO is requesting**
R100,000 in CSI support, or a partial/in-kind contribution structured with the company.

**What the funding would enable**
Direct activities, participation access, safe delivery, community materials, monitoring and a close-out report.

## About ASCO

ASCO is a community-focused civic organisation promoting social justice, community development, active citizenship, African unity, environmental sustainability, inclusion and sustainable public-benefit action. ASCO works through advocacy, education, grassroots initiatives, humanitarian and community-development activities, partnerships and practical interventions.

ASCO is governed by four Directors. The Board governs and Executive Management manages. ASCO maintains governance, donation, safeguarding, financial-management, data-protection, monitoring and reporting instruments for responsible partnership administration.

ASCO's primary contact for this proposal is:

**Mr. Bhekisisa (Mdu) Shandu**
Executive Director
African Solidarity Civic Organisation (ASCO)
PBO Reference: 930092287
Tel: +27 76 757 5773
Website: https://www.africansolidaritycivic.org/

# The proposed project

**Project title**
Youth Green Enterprise and Community Resilience Initiative

**Implementation period**
Proposed 6–12 month pilot, with final schedule agreed after eligibility, baseline and permissions are confirmed.

**Location**
South Africa; select one ASCO-served community after confirming need, municipal permission and Absa's preferred territory (suggested initial focus: Gauteng, subject to validation).

**Target beneficiaries**
Proposed: unemployed or underemployed young people, including young women, from an underserved South African community, plus local schools/community organisations and micro-entrepreneurs who benefit from environmental and financial-literacy activities.

## Proposed outputs and targets

The following are proposed planning targets, not completed results. Final targets should be agreed with the company after baseline assessment, budget confirmation and any required stakeholder permissions.

- Proposed: engage 100 young people in a structured programme combining employability, entrepreneurship, financial literacy and climate/environmental stewardship.
- Proposed: support at least 20 youth-led green or community-benefit micro-project concepts through mentoring and basic enterprise planning.
- Proposed: deliver 4 community workshops on financial literacy, employability, entrepreneurship and climate/community resilience.
- Proposed: implement 2 practical environmental actions (for example, waste reduction, greening or water-saving) with baseline and endline participation/impact records.
- Proposed: publish a close-out report covering attendance, demographic reach, activities, outputs, lessons, expenditure and evidence, subject to Absa's reporting requirements.

## Expected outcomes

- Improved community participation and practical public-benefit action in the selected location.
- Improved access to relevant learning, environmental, inclusion, humanitarian or youth-development support, depending on the project design.
- Documented implementation evidence, beneficiary participation and lessons for continuation or scale-up.
- Clear accountability through expenditure records, activity updates, monitoring information and a close-out report.

# Why this matters

The proposed intervention responds to a community-development need through the sequence **community need → practical intervention → measurable result**. The final baseline will verify the specific need, beneficiary profile, site conditions, permissions and appropriate indicators before implementation.

ASCO will avoid overstating the problem or claiming results in advance. Where waste, participation, learning, environmental condition, referrals or other outputs are measurable, ASCO will use simple evidence tools such as attendance registers, baseline/endline checks, activity logs, photographs with consent, beneficiary feedback and expenditure records.

> **Evidence discipline:** All numbers in this proposal are either company-reported context from official sources or clearly labelled ASCO planning targets. No completed result, partnership or funding commitment is claimed.

## Why Absa Group Limited?

ASCO's proposed South African community-development work could cautiously align with Absa's stated youth employability, entrepreneurship, financial-inclusion, community-resilience and climate-action priorities if the project is framed with measurable outcomes, a credible delivery plan and a clear environmental/social-impact component. A youth-led community resilience and green-skills programme would be thematically relevant, but this is an alignment assessment only and does not imply Absa support, a partnership or eligibility approval.

### Verified company context

- Absa's 2024 sustainability approach is guided by financial inclusion; diversity, equity, inclusion and belonging; and climate action, underpinned by governance and corporate citizenship.
- Absa says its corporate-citizenship priority is to address socio-economic dynamics within its areas of operation and generate sustainable impact.
- In 2024, Absa reported more than R319 million invested in community development, R142 million-plus in entrepreneurship education and youth employability benefiting 33,983 individuals, and 23,437 young people reached through ReadyToWork across its Africa operations.
- Absa's 2024 summary says its social investments reached approximately 5,400 youth, supported 4,672 entrepreneurs including SMEs and smallholder farmers, and included a focus on digital, green and informal economies.
- The 2024 Integrated Report says Absa operates in 12 markets and describes societal interventions including preparing young people for entrepreneurship and the future of work, advancing financial literacy and inclusion, and minimising its business carbon footprint.
- Absa's sponsorship page requests applicant details, a sponsorship description, fee inclusive of taxes, term, territory, objectives, expected benefits, measurement approach and supporting information; it directs submissions to sponsorships@absa.co.za.

Company facts are drawn from official sources reviewed for this proposal. They describe public priorities or reported company activity; they are not promises of funding to ASCO.

## Indicative project budget

The requested amount is allocated transparently across delivery and accountability categories. The budget is indicative and should be refined with the company after the implementation site, beneficiary profile, quotations and eligible-cost rules are confirmed.

| Budget category | Indicative amount | Use |
|---|---|---|
| Direct programme implementation | R60,000 | Core activities, local delivery inputs and community implementation for the proposed project. |
| Participant transport and access | R8,000 | Reasonable access support to enable participation, subject to eligibility and records. |
| Safety equipment and participant welfare | R6,000 | PPE, first aid, safeguarding, water/refreshments and safe participation requirements. |
| Educational and mobilisation materials | R8,000 | Learning resources, community mobilisation and accessible communication. |
| Monitoring, evaluation and reporting | R7,000 | Baseline, attendance, outcome tracking, documentation and close-out reporting. |
| Volunteer/project coordination | R7,000 | Scheduling, volunteer support, stakeholder coordination and implementation management. |
| Reasonable administration | R4,000 | Reasonable project administration directly attributable to delivery; no inflated overheads. |
| **Total requested CSI investment** | **R100,000** | **Equals the proposed request.** |

Administration is limited to a reasonable project share. ASCO will not promise audited financial statements unless they are available; it will provide appropriate project expenditure records and supporting documentation.

## Partnership options

**Option A — Full project funding**
Company funds the proposed project at R100,000, subject to approval and agreement.

**Option B — Partial project funding**
Company contributes a defined portion of the budget, with scope and outputs adjusted transparently.

**Option C — Multi-phase partnership**
Company supports a pilot followed by an agreed continuation or scale-up phase based on evidence.

**In-kind or technical support**
Where relevant, equipment, expertise, access or employee volunteering may complement cash support, subject to written agreement.

## Accountability and reporting

ASCO will maintain appropriate records relating to funded activities and can provide, subject to agreed requirements:

- Project implementation updates
- Expenditure records and supporting documentation
- Attendance and participation information where appropriate and lawfully collected
- Photographs and activity evidence with appropriate consent
- Safeguarding and incident records where relevant
- Monitoring and outcome information
- Activity and close-out reports

ASCO will agree reporting frequency, eligible costs, procurement expectations, data protection, branding, acknowledgement and any site-access or technical requirements before implementation. Any use of company branding or recognition will be subject to written approval.

## Initial contact route

ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.

ASCO welcomes an initial discussion to confirm whether the proposed project is within the company's current CSI/ESG remit, whether unsolicited proposals are accepted, what documents are required, and whether the full, partial or in-kind partnership option is most suitable.

## Important conditions and open questions

- Absa's public sponsorship page does not establish that every CSI or sponsorship proposal is eligible, that nonprofit grants are available, or that a request of R100,000 will be considered.
- The published application route asks for sponsorship benefits and territory; ASCO should confirm whether a public-benefit grant/CSI contribution, rather than a conventional sponsorship, is accepted and what recognition or reporting is required.
- No Absa commitment, existing ASCO partnership, approval or funding decision is evidenced by the cited sources.
- ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.
- A specific Absa geographic eligibility rule, open/close date, excluded activities list, due-diligence checklist and maximum award were not found on the cited public pages and must be confirmed directly.
- The recommended location and targets below are proposals, not verified Absa requirements or existing ASCO results.

These cautions are included to prevent overstatement. They should be resolved with the company before ASCO treats the proposal as eligible or finalises a submission budget.

## Closing

ASCO believes meaningful social and environmental progress is achieved through collaboration between communities, civil society and responsible corporate partners. We invite **Absa Group Limited** to join us in delivering measurable public-benefit impact through a carefully scoped and accountable partnership.

**Mr. Bhekisisa (Mdu) Shandu**
Executive Director
African Solidarity Civic Organisation (ASCO)
PBO Reference: 930092287
Tel: +27 76 757 5773
Website: https://www.africansolidaritycivic.org/

## Official sources and verification links

Important company and programme information in this proposal was checked against the following official sources:

1. https://www.absa.africa/media-statements/2025/absa-releases-2024-sustainability-and-climate-report/
2. https://www.absa.africa/wp-content/uploads/2025/04/Sustainability-and-Climate-Report-Summary.pdf
3. https://www.absa.africa/wp-content/uploads/2025/04/Absa-Group-Limited-Integrated-Report.pdf
4. https://www.absa.africa/absa-sponsorships/

Source review and proposal preparation date: October 2026. Company information and application routes can change; ASCO should confirm current requirements before submission.